Advancing Equity in Psychological Research: Evidence for an Alternative Childhood Trauma Questionnaire-Short Form (CTQ-SF) Model

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Summary

- The CTQ-SF (Bernstein et al., 2003) has demonstrated good psychometrics, but performance may vary across demographic groups
- This study compares the original with an alternative model (Gerdner & Allgulander, 2009) using multi-group confirmatory factor analysis

An alternative Childhood Trauma Questionnaire (CTQ-SF) model outperformed the original, especially among Black college students.



Key Takeaway

- Ensuring measures perform the same across groups advances equity in psychological research
- The alternative CTQ-SF model may improve our ability to understand links between maltreatment and health across demographic groups

Results

CFI + RMSEA χ^2 = Improved Fit

Fit Statistics (Full Sample)

Model	χ^2	df	*p*	CFI	RMSEA	Comparison $\Delta\chi^2$	*df*	*p*
Original	972.76	265	<.01	0.995	0.055			
Alternative	832.32	265	<.01	0.996	0.049	140.446	0	<.001

Note. CFI = Comparative Fit Index; RMSEA = Root Mean Square Error of Approximation

Fit Statistics (Black vs. White)

Model	χ^2	df	CFI	RMSEA	Model	χ^2	df	CFI	RMSEA
Original (White)	438.74	265	0.998	0.038	**Alternative (White)**	434.18	265	0.998	0.037
Original (Black)	805.09	265	0.992	0.069	**Alternative (Black)**	616.66	265	0.995	0.056
Config Original	1243.83	530	0.996	0.055	Config Alternative	1050.84	530	0.997	0.047
Metric Original	1380.80	550	0.995	0.058	Metric Alternative	1128.39	550	0.996	0.049
Scalar Original	1402.62	620	0.995	0.053	Scalar Alternative	1208.42	620	0.996	0.046
Strict Original	1402.62	620	0.995	0.053	Strict Alternative	1208.42	620	0.996	0.046

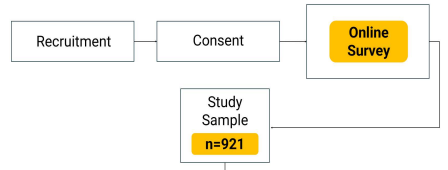
Note. CFI = Comparative Fit Index; RMSEA = Root Mean Square Error of Approximation

Limitations

- Only compared two racial groups
- Study sample was mostly female
- Limited variability in responses

Methods

Procedures and Participants



Demographics				
Mean Age(SD)	**Gender**	**n(%)**	**Race**	**n(%)**
20.6(4.3)	Female	719(78%)	Black	450 (49%)
	Male	202(22%)	White	471 (51%)

Measure:
Childhood Trauma Questionnaire-Short Form (CTQ-SF)

